AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287
Section 18A Approved ? Effective 9 October 2026
+27 76 757 5773
www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Sanlam × ASCO

ASCO Youth Learning and Community Resilience Pilot

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: Gauteng, South Africa (proposed; select a specific underserved community and school/site only after Sanlam confirms geographic and programme fit; Sanlam's published education programme also operates in Eastern Cape, KwaZulu-Natal and Western Cape).

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Sanlam** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **ASCO Youth Learning and Community Resilience Pilot**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** ASCO Youth Learning and Community Resilience Pilot in Gauteng, South Africa (proposed; select a specific underserved community and school/site only after Sanlam confirms geographic and programme fit; Sanlam's published education programme also operates in Eastern Cape, KwaZulu-Natal and Western Cape)., benefiting Proposed: underserved school-age learners and older youth in one selected Gauteng community, with participation from educators, caregivers and community volunteers; final numbers and eligibility to be agreed with the site and Sanlam. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Sanlam's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
ASCO Youth Learning and Community Resilience Pilot

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
Gauteng, South Africa (proposed; select a specific underserved community and school/site only after Sanlam confirms geographic and programme fit; Sanlam's published education programme also operates in Eastern Cape, KwaZulu-Natal and Western Cape).

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: underserved school-age learners and older youth in one selected Gauteng community, with participation from educators, caregivers and community volunteers; final numbers and eligibility to be agreed with the site and Sanlam.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: deliver a 6–9 month pilot combining literacy/numeracy or STEM learning support with youth life-skills and community-development sessions.
- Proposed: reach 100 learners or youth, subject to confirmed site capacity and safeguarding requirements.
- Proposed: train or support 10 educators/community facilitators with practical learning and referral tools.
- Proposed: provide 12 structured group sessions and 2 community engagement events.
- Proposed: establish baseline and endline measures for attendance, participation and selected learning/life-skills indicators, with a concise outcome report.
- Proposed: create a safeguarding, consent, referral and financial-recordkeeping file suitable for funder review.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Sanlam?

A proposed ASCO project could cautiously align with Sanlam's published education-and-skills, youth empowerment and resilient-community priorities if it is designed as a measurable, locally relevant intervention for underserved learners or youth in one of Sanlam's stated South African programme provinces. A credible proposal could combine education support with life skills, community participation and documented outcomes, and could offer employee-volunteering opportunities. This is strategic alignment only; it does not establish eligibility, funding availability, partnership, endorsement or a Sanlam commitment.

Verified company context

- The Sanlam Foundation is a South African registered non-profit welfare organisation incorporated for public benefit and is Sanlam Group's functional lead for CSI initiatives.
- Strategy 2030 describes an integrated pathway connecting education, financial capability, enterprise development and resilient communities, with outcome-based measurement and delivery through trusted partners, employees and the wider Sanlam ecosystem.
- The Foundation's stated impact levers include education and skills, financial capability, enterprise development, resilient communities and employee volunteering.
- Sanlam's education programme covers ECD through secondary school, with reading and home-language development in primary schools and STEM and language at secondary level.
- The official education programme states implementation in Eastern Cape, Gauteng, KwaZulu-Natal and Western Cape; it includes learner support, teacher development, nutrition, career guidance, psychosocial support and digital learning.
- Sanlam's sustainability page identifies social-impact priorities including poverty, education, youth empowerment, health, sustainable small-business support, community resilience and financial inclusion.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R100,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Apply through the official Sanlam Foundation Small Grants Fund portal: https://sanlamfoundation.fluxx.io/user_sessions/new. For partnership enquiries, use sanlamfoundation@sanlam.co.za. Core-funding applications are only accepted when an EOI is published; the official page states none is currently open.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- Sanlam’s core-funding route is conditional on a published EOI, and the official page says there are currently no open EOIs.
- The Small Grants Fund is described as once-off funding for immediate critical social issues and may not be suitable for a multi-year education programme; its full eligibility rules and funding limits should be confirmed through the application portal.
- Sanlam’s published programme geography does not by itself confirm that ASCO’s preferred site or beneficiaries will be accepted; obtain written confirmation of site, age group, delivery partner and budget eligibility.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.
- No Sanlam commitment, existing ASCO partnership, approval, or guaranteed funding has been identified.
- The proposed R100,000 ask is a request, not a published Sanlam award amount or indication of available budget.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Sanlam** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.sanlam.com/sanlam-foundation.php
2. https://www.sanlam.com/sustainability.php
3. https://www.sanlam.com/pdf/foundation/education-programmes-15082025.pdf
4. https://www.sanlam.com/pdf/transformation/2023/supporting-our-communities.pdf
5. https://sanlam-reports.co.za/ebook/2024/
6. https://sanlamfoundation.fluxx.io/user_sessions/new

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.